M_Distortion_Lite

Description

Distortion Lite is a simple animated material designed to create soft UV distortion across a texture.

It uses a distortion texture to gently warp the base texture, creating a more organic and dynamic VFX surface.

This Lite version is intentionally simple and provides only basic distortion controls. It is designed as a lightweight introduction to animated shader materials.

For base texture, tint, emission, and tiling settings, see the **M_BaseColor_Lite** documentation.

Use Cases

Recommended for:

- Magic energy surfaces
- Soft animated VFX planes
- Portal surface distortion
- Heat-like stylized warping
- Organic energy movement
- Fantasy glow materials
- Decorative VFX surfaces
- Preview materials for the full shader packs

Distortion Parameters

Distortion Texture

Primary texture used to create the distortion pattern.

Recommended texture type:

Seamless grayscale noise
Soft fluid noise
Organic distortion map

Medium contrast utility texture

The included recommended texture:

T_Noise_Distortion_Soft_01

This texture is designed for subtle organic distortion, soft energy movement, heat-style warping, and magic VFX surfaces.

Distortion Speed

Default: `0.15`

Controls how fast the distortion pattern moves.

Recommended values:

0 — static distortion
0.05 — very slow movement
0.15 — default soft motion
0.3 — more visible movement
0.5+ — fast stylized distortion

Use lower values for calm magical surfaces or background effects.
Use higher values for active energy, portals, or stronger animated VFX.

Distortion Strength

Default: `0.02`

Controls how strongly the distortion texture warps the base texture.

Recommended values:

0 — no distortion
0.01 — very subtle distortion
0.02 — default soft distortion
0.03 — clearly visible distortion
0.05+ — strong stylized distortion

For most materials, keep this value subtle.
High values can make the texture harder to read.

Recommended Settings

Soft Magic Distortion

Distortion Speed: 0.05–0.15
Distortion Strength: 0.01–0.02

Best for calm energy surfaces, subtle movement, and decorative VFX.

Portal Surface Distortion

Distortion Speed: 0.15–0.3
Distortion Strength: 0.02–0.04

Best for portal planes, magical gates, energy walls, and animated surface effects.

Strong Stylized Distortion

Distortion Speed: 0.3–0.6
Distortion Strength: 0.04–0.08

Best for more active VFX surfaces or exaggerated stylized motion.

Use stronger settings carefully, especially on detailed or high-contrast textures.

Best Practices

- Use seamless distortion textures for best results.
- Keep Distortion Strength low for clean and readable motion.
- Use soft noise textures for smooth organic distortion.
- Use stronger distortion only for stylized showcase effects.
- Combine Distortion Speed with texture tiling to control the perceived motion density.
- Use Bloom in the scene for stronger glowing results.
- For gameplay surfaces, avoid very high Distortion Strength values.
- For advanced distortion, multiple noise layers, direction controls, masks, pulse, wave blending, or stronger animation options, use the full shader packs.

Limitations

This Lite material is intentionally simplified.

It does not include:

- Advanced distortion controls
- Multiple distortion layers
- Public distortion direction control
- Distortion mask controls
- Noise contrast controls
- Dual texture blending
- Pulse controls
- Radial or vortex motion
- Opacity / alpha controls
- Custom gradient color mode
- Advanced masking

This material is designed as a lightweight free version for simple animated distortion-style VFX.

Summary

Distortion Lite provides:

- Simple animated UV distortion
- Distortion texture input
- Adjustable distortion speed
- Adjustable distortion strength
- Lightweight stylized VFX behavior
- A beginner-friendly preview of the G-Spot Lab shader workflow

For base texture, tint, emission, and tiling controls, see the **M_BaseColor_Lite** documentation.